

Section B

2.5) Answer the following in about 150 words each:

10x5=50

(a) Witchcraft belief and social control

Radcliffe Brown said that social sanctions are required to ensure social control and social order.

Witchcraft as per Kluckhohn is the belief that a witch has bewitched the social order using malice and ill will.

Evans Pritchard and Study of Azande:-

If a famine, illness, etc befalls town, people consult an oracle. The oracle directs people to a witch that is assumed to have caused ill will.

This STOPS DEVIANCE in behaviour. Next time someone tries to break sanction they recall the curse of the witch.

Thus (a) WITCHCRAFT "institutionalises emotions".

(b) It creates an internalised and externalised control mechanism for social control.

Features of witchcraft belief and social control :-

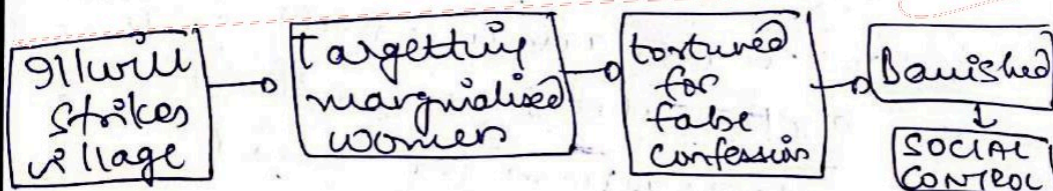
- The isolated and downtrodden are usually targeted.
- Used to stoke fear in minds of children as part of social control.
- Witches do not practice magic but are assumed to bring ill will.

Legitimacy to this form of social control (Kluckhohn) :-

- Found in myths of culture
- Found in customary laws

Downside of witchcraft belief :-

UN study shows that 2500 women have been hunted down as witches. The downtrodden, widows, prophetic women are tormented in blind faith.



Arundhati Aggarwal said that law must plug holes in areas to protect women.